

Define Problem Statements

Project: Automated Network Request Management (ServiceNow)

1. Context

Employees and teams regularly require network changes — VPN access, firewall rule updates, new port openings, site-to-site connectivity, or guest network access — to perform their jobs. The current process for requesting such network changes is informal, inconsistent, and lacks visibility for both the requester and the approver.

2. Core Problem Statement

“Employees and teams have no standardized, trackable way to request network changes or access, resulting in delayed fulfillment, inconsistent manager approval, and no visibility into network capacity, security review status, or change risk — creating friction for employees, managers, and the IT/Network support team.”

3. Supporting Problem Statements (by Persona)

Persona	Problem Statement
Employee	As an employee, I don't have a simple, guided way to request a network change (e.g., VPN access, firewall rule, new connectivity), and I have no visibility into whether my request was received, approved, or is being worked on.
Manager	As a manager, I receive ad-hoc requests to approve via email or verbally, with no central place to review, approve, or reject them, and no record of my decision.
IT / Network Team	As a member of the IT/Network team, I receive fulfillment requests with inconsistent details and no structured task queue, making prioritization, security review, and tracking difficult.
Organization	As an organization, we have no audit trail of who requested what network access, who approved it, and whether network capacity or security exposure is being tracked appropriately.

4. Impact of the Problem

- Delayed network changes slow down employee and team productivity.
- Managers lack a consistent approval record for compliance/audit purposes.
- IT/Network teams cannot prioritize, risk-assess, or track fulfillment work effectively.
- No mechanism exists to flag or handle capacity or security constraints proactively.

5. Desired Outcome

A digital, workflow-driven request-to-fulfillment process built on ServiceNow, where: employees/teams submit requests through a guided Service Catalog form; requests are automatically routed to the correct manager for approval; approved requests generate a fulfillment task for the IT/Network team; and any request that cannot be fulfilled (e.g., due to capacity constraints or security policy conflict) automatically raises an incident for follow-up.

6. Success Criteria

- An employee can submit a network request in under 2 minutes via the Service Catalog.
- A manager can approve or reject a request directly from their My Approvals list.
- An approved request automatically creates a task assigned to the Network/IT Support team.

- A request that cannot be fulfilled automatically raises a tracked incident, with no manual step required.
- Every request has a clear, auditable status at every stage (Requested → Approved/Rejected → In Progress → Closed).